



GENE CHIPS

Doctors can now scan your DNA for thousands of different genes—the pieces of DNA that control how the body works—by using a biochip. These chips contain thousands of DNA sensors and may help predict your chances of developing a range of diseases.

◀ BIOCHIP SCAN

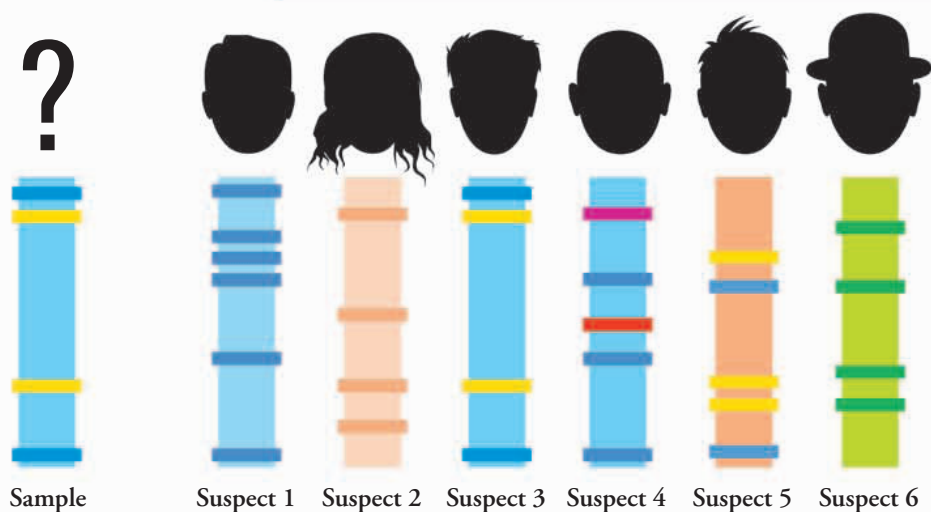
A sample of DNA from one person is dropped onto a biochip containing thousands of sensors. It's then scanned for any matches.

WOW!

Only three percent of your DNA forms the genes that make you what you are.

DNA FINGERPRINTS

Everyone, except for identical twins, has a slightly different genome. This means that a criminal who leaves a speck of blood, saliva, or a hair at a crime scene can be identified from the DNA it contains. Scientists extract the DNA in the sample and use it to generate a “DNA fingerprint” with its own unique pattern. They then compare this with the DNA fingerprints of any criminal suspects. Can you see a DNA match for the sample shown here?



GENETIC IDENTITY

One day, we may all have to carry an identity card like this one featuring our genetic information. It has a fingerprint, personal data in the form of a bar code, a coded pattern of the holder's iris, and information about her genome encoded in a special electronic chip. Such genetic information would be difficult to fake or deny, meaning that people could be identified more quickly and accurately.

